# THE MARVEL WAY

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## The Origin Story

*Marvel*, the most iconic comic book publishing company to dawn upon our existence, has brought some of the most recognizable super hero's and villains to our world, from the *X-Men*, to the *Fantastic 4*, to the *Incredible Hulk and Spider-Man*.

Originally *Timely Comics*, founded by publisher Martin Goodman in 1939, *Marvel* has produced legendary artists and writers that have collaborated to give these notable comic book figures both story and form. *Marvel* figureheads such as writer Stan Lee and artist/writer Jack Kirby take the crown, as they are considered the founding fathers of the *Marvel*, comic book enthusiast have come to know and love. Other dynamic creators include, Steve Ditko and Todd McFarlane, who reinvented the entire look and energy of *Spider-Man* in 1988.

Through this presentation, I aim is to give insight into just how dynamic these collaborations have been throughout *Marvel's* entire history.

## The Endgame

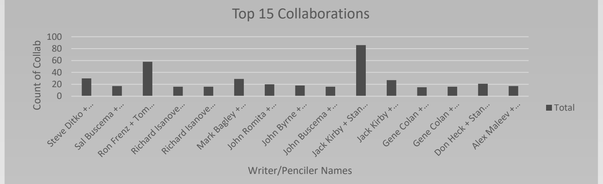
The dataset used in this mission presents every *Marvel* comic published throughout its history. However, the original dataset needed some damage control, cleaning up null values, organizing which pencilers/writers collaborated together and much more.

Many writers and artists have cemented themselves into the *Marvel* universe through the decades since its inception, however, the endgame is to see which of these writers and pencilers have collaborations as dynamic as the *Avengers themselves*.

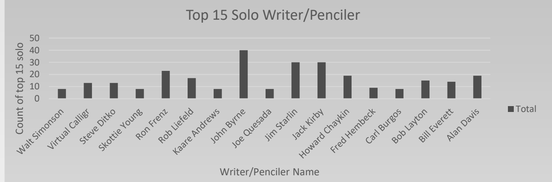
Specifically, I dive into which writers/pencilers have had overall the most collaborations and how many comics they have published together. I also take a look at creators who did solo work on a comic series. Important also is the duration, or how long an issue lasted.

## Directives

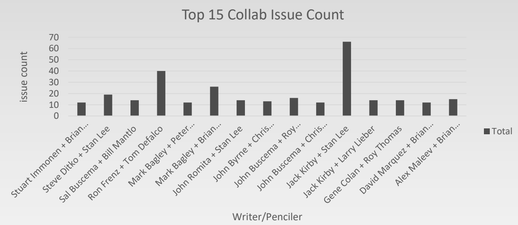
The first objective is to define which legendary *Marvel* artist/writer have had the most collaborations, limited to the top 15.



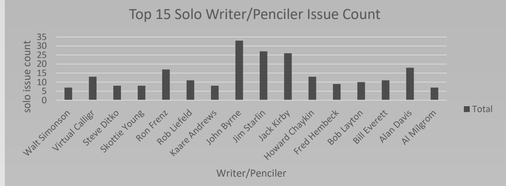

Now lets take a look at the top 15 solo writer/pencilers



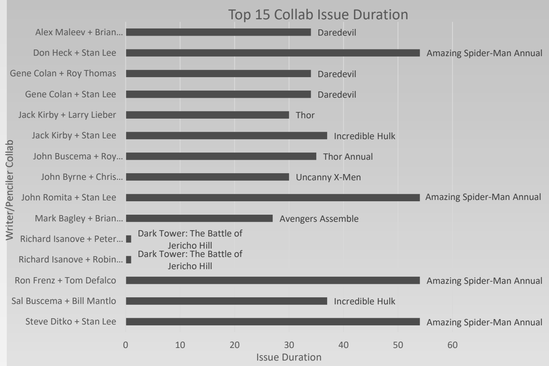

### Top 15 Collab Issue Count



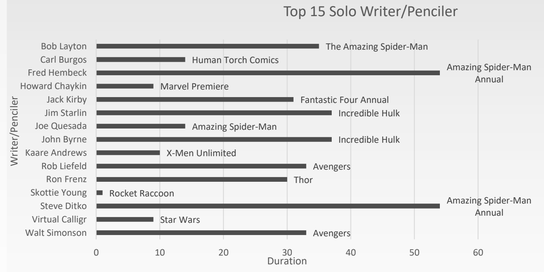

### Top 15 Solo Writer/Penciler Issue Count




### Top 15 Collab Issue Duration




### Top 15 Solo Writer/Penciler Issue Duration




## The Aftermath

Clearly Stan Lee, Jack Kirby, John Byrne, Steve Ditko, Ron Frenz, Tom Defalco and issue titles such as *The Amazing Spider-Man* and *The Incredible Hulk* stand out as the most dynamic writer/penciler pairings and comic series *Marvel* has witnessed.

Despite the weight carried by these names and titles, entertainment executives should keep in my things such as familiarity with certain comic issues, as pencilers/writers may be known for a specific work/s. These specific team ups may better understand the energy, vibe, personalities and overall lore needed for a specific comic book series.

Also, there should be an understanding that not all of these writer/pencilers did solo work on a comic series such is the case with Fred Hembeck.

## References

To also better understand the success of writer/pencilers and their specific comic series, I would like to see which of these series such as *The Amazing Spider-Man Annual* and *The Incredible Hulk* generated in revenue over their durations and how many times their stories were brought to motion picture and then take a look at how much revenue they generated at the box office.

I would also like to take a look at when certain writers/pencilers picked up a series where it last left off and how long that specific collaboration lasted and the issue counts that were published under that collaboration, as is the case when Sal Buscema and Bill Mantlo picked up *The Incredible Hulk* where Stan Lee and Jack Kirby left off.

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